NovaPlay Site Test Guide

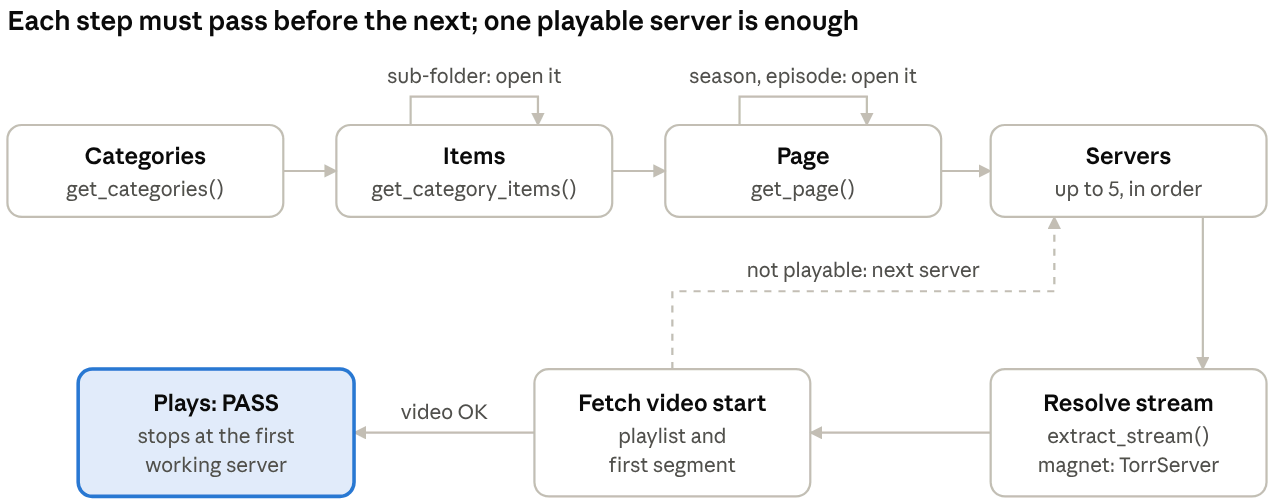
Oct 16, 2026 · @westy

What it does

`run_site_test.py` checks a site the way the plugin uses it, against the real website, and tells you which step breaks. It runs the same extractor code the plugin runs, step by step, and finishes by downloading the first few kilobytes of the actual video with the headers the player would send.

The chain it walks:

1. **Categories**: `get_categories()` returns the site's menu.
2. **Items**: `get_category_items()` on the first category that has titles, opening sub-folders if a category holds only folders.
3. **Search**: `search()` with the first word of the first title found (or your own word).
4. **Page**: `get_page()` on the first title, then into season and episode until servers appear.
5. **Servers**: `extract_stream()` on each server, with the site's cookies attached, as the plugin does.
6. **Stream**: fetches the start of the video. For HLS it checks the master playlist, the quality playlist and the first segment.



test chain · 7 steps, 3 loops

A failure early in the chain stops the test there; a dead server only moves it on to the next one.

Nothing is played, saved or changed. Enigma2 doesn't need to be stopped, and the plugin can stay open.

Before you start

The script lives in the plugin folder next to `run_tests.py` and `run_release_gate.py`. Open a terminal on the box (SSH or Telnet) and go there first:

```
cd /usr/lib/enigma2/python/Plugins/Extensions/AdvancedArabicPlayer
```

- **Get or update it:** copy `run_site_test.py` from the `novaplay-modular` repo into that folder. Update it whenever the repo has a newer version.
- **No restart needed:** it loads the extractors fresh each time it runs. Restart Enigma2 (`init 4 && init 3`) only for the plugin's own screens to pick up changed files.
- **Same settings as the plugin:** it applies your browser-proxy setting from the plugin's Settings, so Cloudflare-protected sites behave as they do on screen.
- **Python 3:** run it with `python3`. It uses only what the plugin already uses.

Commands

Give it either a site key or a path to an extractor file, plus any options.

Command	What it does
`python3 run_site_test.py --list`	Shows every site key, for example `sflix_pro`, `egydead`, `yts`
`python3 run_site_test.py sflix_pro`	Full test of one site: categories to stream
`python3 run_site_test.py --all`	Quick check of every site: categories and items only, then a summary
`python3 run_site_test.py extractors/new_site.py`	Tests a file that isn't registered yet, such as a new or generated extractor
`... egydead --search "batman"`	Tests search with your word instead of the automatic one

Command	What it does
`... sflix_pro --page sflix_movie_1153576`	Skips browsing and tests one title directly, using the URL the extractor gives that title
`... sflix_pro --servers 8`	Tries up to 8 servers instead of the default 5
`... sflix_pro --all-servers`	Keeps testing after a working server, to see which servers work

Options can be combined, for example `python3 run_site_test.py cineby --page cineby_movie_969681 --all-servers`.

By default it stops at the first server that plays, because that answers "does this site work". Use `--all-servers` when you want the full server picture, for example to decide the server order.

Reading the report

Each step prints one status line, its time in seconds, and indented details. The last line gives the verdict.

Status	Meaning	Counts as
`PASS`	The step worked	OK
`WARN`	It worked, but something is missing or odd (no posters, empty search, downloads only)	Warning
`BAD`	One server didn't work. Sites with several servers usually have a few dead ones	Warning
`FAIL`	The site can't be used past this point (no items, no page, or no server plays)	Failure

The verdict:

- `PASSED`: every step worked.
- `PASSED with warnings`: the site works and at least one server plays, but some things need a look.
- `FAILED`: a user would hit a dead end. The `FAIL` line above it says where.

An example, step by step (a series on a site with four servers):

```
[PASS] get_categories() (0.4s)
         12 categories; testing 'Action'
[WARN] get_category_items('Action') (2.1s)
         24 items (+1 navigation entries)
         first: 'Batman Begins' -> https://site/series/batman
         3 of 24 item(s) have no poster
[PASS] search('Batman') (1.8s)
[PASS] get_page(https://site/series/batman) (1.2s)
         title: 'Batman Begins' | type: series | servers: 0 | sub-items: 2
         -> opening first sub-item (season/episode)
[PASS] get_page(https://site/season/1) (0.9s)
[PASS] get_page(https://site/episode/1) (1.1s)
         title: 'E1' | type: episode | servers: 4 | sub-items: 0
[BAD ] server 1/4: Dood (3.0s)
         extract_stream found no stream
[BAD ] server 2/4: Uqload (2.4s)
         stream request failed: HTTP 403 Forbidden
         headers sent: User-Agent
[PASS] server 3/4: VidHide (2.2s)
         resolved [720p]: https://cdn.../master.m3u8|Referer=https://...
         HLS OK: 3 variant(s), 512 segment(s), first segment HTTP 200
         (1 more server(s) not tested -- add --all-servers to test them)
RESULT: PASSED with warnings  (0 fail, 3 warn)
saved: /tmp/site_test_egydead.txt
```

Reading it: browsing works, a few posters are missing, the series opened down to an episode, and 2 of the first 3 servers are dead. The third plays, so the site works for users. Server 2 failed with only `User-Agent` sent, which points to a missing `Referer` in that host's resolver.

Files and exit codes:

- Each run saves its report to `/tmp/site_test_<site>.txt`. `--all` saves the summary to `/tmp/site_test_ALL.txt`.
- The plugin's own detailed log keeps going to `/tmp/arabicplayer.log`. Look there for the reason behind a failed step.
- Exit code `0` means passed (with or without warnings), `1` means failed, and `2` means the command was wrong (for example an unknown site key).

How each site type is handled

The test follows the same rules as the plugin's screens, so all 31 registered sites are covered.

Site type	Examples	How the test treats it
Arabic scraper sites	EgyDead, WeCima, Akwam, Arabseed, Shahid4u, CimaWebas	Normal chain. The site's cookies are attached to the stream, as the plugin does
TMDB-based sites	SFlix, Cineby, Vidsrc, IMDB.su	Normal chain. Categories come from TMDB, servers are embed players
Torrent sites	YTS, Torrentio	`magnet:` servers count as working and go to TorrServer, as in the plugin. Nothing is downloaded
Series	any site	Follows series, then season, then episode (up to 4 levels), opening only the types the detail screen lists: `series`, `season`, `episode`
Categories with sub-folders	genre or collection menus	Opens the first sub-folder (up to 3 levels) when a category holds no titles
Download-only pages	some movie pages	`WARN`, not `FAIL`: the blue download key still works in the plugin
Cloudflare-protected sites	several Arabic sites	Uses your browser-proxy setting, so results match what you see on screen
Site families	EgyDead / Coupons / CA, Arabseed x3, Akwam x2	Each member is its own site key. Test them one by one, or use `--all`

Next-page tiles ("Next", "التالي", "Page 2") are never counted as titles.

Common results and what to do

Message	Likely cause	What to do
`returned an empty list` (items)	Site down, blocked, moved domain, or its page layout changed	Open the site on your PC. If it loads, capture it with Stream Recorder Pro and send the JSON
`no usable categories`	Extractor broken at the start, or site unreachable	Check `/tmp/arabicplayer.log` for the first error
`timed out after 90s`	Site extremely slow or hanging	Run it again. If it repeats, the site may need the browser proxy
`extract_stream found no stream`	That host changed or has no resolver	Normal for one server. If every server shows it, capture a working server in the browser
`HTTP 403 Forbidden`, `headers sent: User-Agent`	Host needs a `Referer` or `Origin` the resolver doesn't send	Send me the report: usually a one-line resolver fix
`got an HTML page instead of video`	Link expired, blocked, or wrong headers	Re-run. If it repeats, send the report
`first segment failed`	Playlist works, video pieces are blocked	Usually a header the segments need. Send the report
`no stream servers, but N download link(s)`	Page has downloads only	Fine for users. Downloads aren't tested
`no servers and nothing to open`	Page parsed, but servers weren't found	Layout changed on the watch page. Capture it
`none of the N server(s) tried produced a playable stream`	Every server tried is dead	Try `--servers 10`. If still none, the site needs work
`HTTP Error 404` or `Connection refused` in a server	That mirror is gone	Ignore if another server plays
`unknown site key`	Typo in the key	Use `--list` to see the exact keys

Workflows

Weekly health check (about 5 minutes)

1. Run `python3 run_site_test.py --all`.
2. Look at the summary. Any site marked `FAIL` has broken browsing.
3. Run the full test on each failed site, for example `python3 run_site_test.py egydead`, to see which step breaks.

After changing or updating a file

1. Copy the new file onto the box.
2. Run the full test for the site it affects, for example `python3 run_site_test.py sflix_pro --all-servers`.
3. When it passes, restart Enigma2 (`init 4 && init 3`) and try it on screen.

Testing a new or generated extractor

1. Put the file in `extractors/`, for example `extractors/new_site.py`. It doesn't need to be in the registry yet.
2. Run `python3 run_site_test.py extractors/new_site.py`.
3. Fix whatever the first `FAIL` points at, then run it again.
4. Register it in `extractors/registry.py` only once it passes.

Sending results for help

- Send `/tmp/site_test_<site>.txt`. It's short and has everything the test saw.
- For a failed server, also send the last 100 lines of the plugin log: `tail -100 /tmp/arabicplayer.log`.
- If the site needs a new resolver, add a Stream Recorder Pro capture of the working server from your PC: `networkLog`, `xhrBodies` and `frameDocuments`.

What it doesn't test

- **Downloads:** it reports download links but doesn't download them.
- **Playback on the box:** it confirms the stream is reachable and is real video, not that the box's player decodes it. A `PASS` that won't play on screen points to the player or codec side.
- **Every title:** it tests the first title of the first working category. Another title can still have a dead server.

- **Subtitles, TMDB posters and the home screen layout.**
- **TorrServer:** magnet links are counted as working, but TorrServer itself isn't contacted.
- **Pages beyond the first** of a category, and every season of a series: it opens only the first of each.